



Arena of Valor in USA

Tencent's popular MOBA game "Arena of Valor" is arriving in the US on December 19. <http://dgit.in/10cntAOV>



Danny Ocean might be dead

A new snapshot from the upcoming Ocean's 8 movie suggests that the lead from the previous series might be dead. <http://dgit.in/DOcean8>

also provide additional mobile SDKs for chatbot deployment specifically on your Android and/or iOS apps as well as Javascript SDKs for the same on your websites. If you still haven't guessed it, yes, expertise in various SDKs will come in very handy.

When we come to the backend, there are quite a few systems working in tandem. "There are APIs which consume the message, databases which provide easy access to data and an intelligent layer of Natural Language Processing which processes the message and figures out a reply for the user", Swapan explains, "These systems and algorithms can be built using various languages; for instance, we mainly use Python at Haptik. For NLP you can also write your own algorithms using various different open source libraries such as scikit-learn, nltk and many others."

Apart from technical skills, there are a couple other areas that are quite important to a good chatbot experiences – an education in linguistics, psychology, or sociology could also provide a perspective that is needed for a good, and immersive, conversational experience.

BUT WHERE DO I WORK?

Globally, chatbots are entering every segment of technology imaginable. But when it comes to India, the market is quite nascent, which is a good thing. There is promise in a few areas at the moment. "The most popular bot

use-cases include marketing, sales and support," says Beerud Sheth, CEO and Co-founder, Gupshup, "Marketing bots are helping marketers qualify leads and route to right salesperson and more. Sales bots are enabling transactions through chat and also help with product discovery and evaluation. The support bots mainly automate recurring support queries and help with handing over to human agents when required."

If you're planning to enter this field, it is highly likely that you will end up working for a company that has its own chatbot development platform. After leaders in the field like Haptik and Gupshup, even upcoming startups have established goals of coming up with their own bot-developing platform. Indian-founded, California-based Botworx.ai, that raised \$3mn

earlier this year in venture funding, claims that their system is flexible and can work with third party NLP engines in order to do things like use a voice recognition processor for voice input, or an NLP engine for an unsupported local language, or even more enterprise-usage scenarios, such as interfacing with popular NLP offerings from Facebook, Amazon, etc., and even CRMs and more.

WHAT LIES IN THE FUTURE?

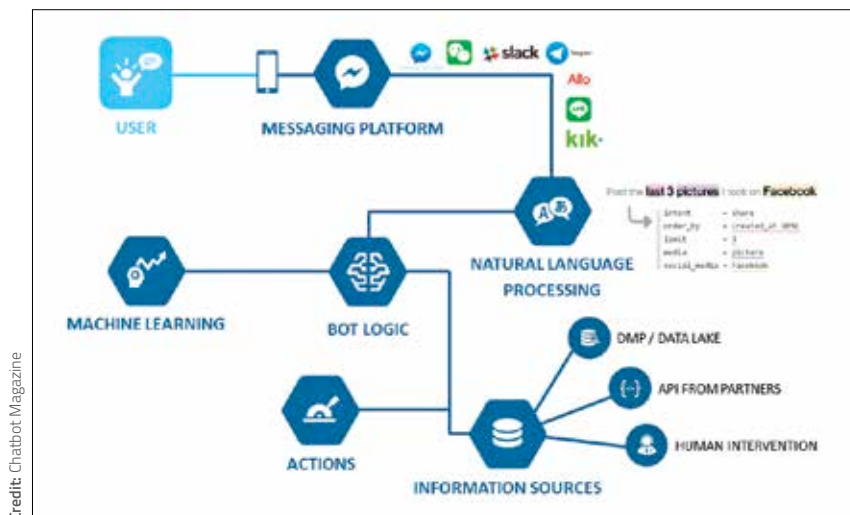
Even with chatbots being highly promising as a prospective technology paradigm, there are already quite a few specific roadblocks in its way. For instance, discoverability on platforms like Facebook, Slack etc. is an issue, along with big platforms like WhatsApp still not being open to chatbots (that might change soon though with WhatsApp for Business). Additionally, no matter what forecasts might say, bots today are not equipped to surpass human interaction. Most of them can't even hold their own in a simple conversation that extends even slightly beyond their intended use case. And these roadblocks are important because they might decide whether chatbots get discarded as a fad or are bettered and accepted by users at large.

HELPFUL LINKS:

- Chatbot list: <https://botlist.co/>
- Bots on FB Messenger: <http://dgit.in/MessBots>
- Slack bots: <http://dgit.in/Slackbot>

HOW DO I LEARN?

All the skills mentioned in this article can be learnt separately, but there are quite a few over arching areas that can be covered in well-designed courses. Swapan says, "Andrew Ng's – Machine Learning course (<http://dgit.in/MLAndrew>) on Coursera is a great way to learn the basics of ML. Once you are good with the basics of ML, diving deep into different NLP algorithm will help you get an edge in the industry. Understanding Natural Language Tool Kit ([nltk.org](http://dgit.in/nltk.org)) is a great way to learn as well." Another good skill to have is system architecture design, for which you can find a highly recommended course from MIT here: <http://dgit.in/MITSys-Arch>. And if you want to get your hands dirty right away, without too much coding, you aren't short of options either with Dialogflow from Google and Messenger Platform from Facebook for basic bot creation, for free!



The flow of a chatbot operation